

1. datasette-referrer-policy 0.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-05T23:44:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/5/datasette-referrer-policy/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-referrer-policy 0.1 The OpenStreetMap tiles on the Datasette global-power-plants demo weren't displaying correctly. This turned out to be caused by two bugs. The first is that the CAPTCHA I added to that site a few weeks ago was triggering for the .json fetch requests used by the map plugin, and since those weren't HTML the user was not being asked to solve them. Here's the fix . The second was that OpenStreetMap quite reasonably block tile requests from sites that use a Referrer-Policy: no-referrer header. Datasette does this by default, and I didn't want to change that default on people without warning - so I had Codex + GPT-5.5 build me a new plugin to help set that header to another value. Tags: openstreetmap , http , datasette

2. Our AI started a cafe in Stockholm

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-05T22:14:21+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/5/our-ai-started-a-cafe-in-stockholm/#atom-everything>

Our AI started a cafe in Stockholm Andon Labs previously started an AI-run retail store in San Francisco. Now they're running a similar experiment in Stockholm, Sweden, only this time it's a cafe. These experiments are interesting, and often throw out amusing anecdotes: During the first week of inventory, Mona ordered 120 eggs even though the caf  has no stove. When the staff told her they couldn't cook them, she suggested using the high-speed oven, until they pointed out the eggs would likely explode. She also tried to solve the problem of fresh tomatoes being spoiled too fast by ordering 22.5 kg of canned tomatoes for the fresh sandwiches. The baristas eventually started a "Hall of Shame", a shelf visible to customers with all the weird things Mona ordered, including 6,000 napkins, 3,000 nitrile gloves, 9L coconut milk, and industrial-sized trash bags. Where they lose their shine is when these AI managers start wasting the time of human beings who have not opted into the experiment: She also successfully applied for an outdoor seating permit through the Police e-service, which didn't require BankID. Her first submission included a sketch she had generated herself, despite having...

3. datasette-llm 0.1a7

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-05T01:56:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/5/datasette-llm/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-llm 0.1a7 Mechanism for configuring default options for specific models. Part of Datasette's evolving support mechanism for plugins that use LLMs. It's now possible to configure a model with default options, e.g. to say all enrichment operations should use a specific model with temperature set to 0.5. Tags: llm , datasette

4. Apple Cuts More Mac Studio and Mac Mini RAM Options as Memory Shortage Worsens

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-06T00:36:29Z

Link: <https://www.macrumors.com/2026/05/05/apple-mac-studio-mac-mini-ram-cuts/>

Juli Clover, MacRumors: Apple has removed more desktop Macs from its online store as the global memory shortage continues. Mac mini models with 32GB and 64GB of RAM are no longer available for purchase, nor is the M3 Ultra Mac Studio with 256GB RAM. The M3 Ultra Mac Studio is now available only in a 96GB RAM configuration, with higher-tier options eliminated. Both M3 Mac Studio and M4 Max Mac Studio models have delivery estimates of 9 to 10 weeks. ?

5. Apple Settles Class Action Lawsuit Over AI Features That Were Advertised but Didn't Ship for \$250 Million

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-06T00:29:22Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/05/05/apple-reaches-250m-settlement-over-siri-delays-users-could>

-get-up-to-95-per-device/

Chance Miller, 9to5Mac: Last March, Apple was hit with a class action lawsuit after delaying the launch of the "more personalized Siri" that was first announced at WWDC 2024. Apple agreed to settle the case in December, and the full settlement terms are now available. Apple is set to pay \$250 million to settle the lawsuit, equating to an estimated \$25 per device. That number could reach up to \$95 per device, depending on how many users submit claims. [...] As part of the settlement, Apple is not admitting any wrongdoing. The company continues to assert that "it acted in good faith and in a manner reasonably believed to be in accordance with all applicable rules, regulations, and laws." In a statement to 9to5Mac, an Apple spokesperson said: Since the launch of Apple Intelligence, we have introduced dozens of features across many languages that are integrated across Apple's platforms, relevant to what users do every day, and built with privacy protections at every step. These include Visual Intelligence, Live Translation, Writing Tools, Genmoji, Clean Up and many more. Apple has reached a settlement to resolve claims related to the availability of two additional features. We resolve...

6. The Pentagon Pegs the Cost of the Iran War, So Far, at \$25 Billion

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-05T21:55:53Z

Link: <https://politicalwire.com/2026/04/29/iran-war-has-cost-25-billion-so-far/>

Taegan Goddard, quoting the Financial Times last week: The Pentagon said President Trump's Iran war has cost the United States at least \$25 billion, driven primarily by the military's use of munitions, the Financial Times reports . The New York Times had an interesting piece trying to put that number in context (gift link): \$25 billion is similar to: The annual budget of NASA. Spending on military aid to Israel after Oct. 7. Spending by U.S.A.I.D. before it was disbanded. The cost to expand Obamacare subsidies for one year. These are all comparisons to other aspects of the U.S. federal budget. It's interesting also to use this in comparison with the current moment in tech: OpenAI's latest valuation of \$852 billion (I love the 2) equals 34 Iran Wars. Anthropic's \$380 billion valuation equals 15 Iran Wars. Apple's current four-year U.S. manufacturing commitment of "more than \$500 billion" equals 20 Iran Wars. Google expects to spend between \$91.93 billion in capital expenditures this calendar year, mostly related to AI infrastructure. That's a little over 3 Iran Wars this year. Larry Ellison currently has a net worth of \$220 billion . That's just short of 9 Iran Wars. But since the...

7. A dispute over the TAB key highlights a mismatch between Microsoft and IBM organizational structures

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260505-00/?p=112298>

I want to speak to your manager. The post A dispute over the TAB key highlights a mismatch between Microsoft and IBM organizational structures appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Straightforward checklists don't fit every situation

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-05T03:29:23Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/ChecklistsDontFitEverything>

We had a weekend long power shutdown this past weekend in the building with our main machine room. As is our custom, we powered off the servers before hand (on Friday evening, with some surprises), and then turned them back on this morning. This isn't the first time we've gone through such a power shutdown (although usually they're shorter), and over time we've written checklists and lessons learned for these things . This time was no exception, so I wrote checklists for both powering down everything and powering it back up (well in advance for once). Then we collectively looked at my nice, detailed, step by step power on checklist and ripped it up. The issue is that powering things up in our environment is not really an orderly, step by step process. A lot of our systems are both core things and relatively independent of each other, and while there are ordering dependencies (our file servers have to be up before any NFS client, for example, and the DNS resolvers need to be up before the file servers), they're small and at the start. Even in the ordering there's a lot that can be done at once, such as booting up all of the file servers at once. This structure, or lack of it, doesn't...

9. Changing one character in a PDF

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 22:45:26 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/05/changing-one-character-in-a-pdf/>

I saw a post on X saying Changing a hyphen to an en-dash increases your PDF file size by ~10 bytes. My first thought was that it had something to do with hyphen being an ASCII character and an en-dash not. Changing a hyphen to an en-dash would make a UTF-8 encoded text file a [?] The post Changing one character in a PDF first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. RSS Feeds Send Me More Traffic Than Google

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 11:34:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/rss-feeds-send-me-more-traffic-than-google/>

Yeah yeah, I know, data-point of 1. I recently read Susam's blog post where they said that "most of the traffic to my personal website still comes from web feeds" - I wondered if that was true for my site. I've been writing this blog for a while. I've never much bothered with "aggressive" SEO - I have a fairly semantic layout, all my reviews have metadata, and stuff like that - but I'm not?

11. Package Manager Threat Models

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-05T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/05/package-manager-threat-models.html>

The previous post catalogued the bugs that get filed against package managers: path traversal in the extractor, argument injection in the git driver, XSS in the registry's README renderer. Things you can find by reading code, point at a line number, and patch. This post is the other half. The properties below are working as designed, so nobody files a CVE for them. They're also where almost every supply-chain incident with a name actually came from. In event-stream , ua-parser-js , left-pad , and xz , the package manager did exactly what it was built to do. If the first post was a list of patterns to grep for, this one is a list of questions to answer in prose. The output of working through it is a few paragraphs per heading describing what the tool actually does, because the answers differ a lot from one tool to the next and most of them aren't written down anywhere except the source. Client Code execution at install time The single biggest design decision a package manager makes, and the one most of the incident record hangs off, is whether install runs code from the package: on the user's machine, with their privileges, with access to their environment, before they've seen a li...

12. Emotional regulation is a dying art.

Source: Westenberg. | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 00:21:50 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenberg.com/emotional-regulation-is-a-dying-art/>

There was a time when adults could feel something without screaming at you about it. We could disagree, hard, in a meeting and walk out with our faces still attached. Bad news arrived at the dinner table and the meal finished anyway. Call it discipline: the capacity to feel a

13. Outrage is letting someone else set the frame

Source: Westenberg. | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 06:20:33 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenberg.com/outrag/>

William Randolph Hearst bought the New York Morning Journal in 1895 - and immediately started running stories designed to make his readers furious before they'd finished their breakfast. The pages manufactured a mood, and that mood sold papers. Three years later, when his correspondent Frederic Remington cabled from

14. Pluralistic: The three armies fighting for the post-American world (05 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 12:31:41 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/05/three-is-a-magic-number/>

Today's links The three armies fighting for the post-American world: Hippies, investors and

hawks. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: NK dictator's son v Tokyo Disneyland; Mainstream press and Bushies v Colbert; Taliban v Pakistan's first McDonald's; Norwegian sovereign wealth fund v exec compensation; Copyright v cheerleader uniforms; Dishwashers are iPhones. Upcoming appearances: Guelph, Barcelona, Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. The three armies fighting for the post-American world (permalink) Political change is downstream of coalition building, and coalitions are fragile things, because by definition they are not fully aligned; they share some goals but often violently disagree about others. A coalition forms when groups set aside their differences to pursue the common elements of their agenda. Trump is a master coalition builder. He wouldn't have been able to seize and wield so much power without a coalition that includes people who absolutely hate each other and want ea...

15. Fizz Buzz Through Monoids

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/fizzbuzz-through-monoids>

Some decade ago I read a good implementation of fizzbuzz. What set it apart was its excellent modularity. The original article is no longer on the web, but this is my reconstruction: module Main where import Control.Monad (guard) import Data.Foldable (for_) import Data.Maybe (fromMaybe) fizzbuzz i = fromMaybe (show i) . mconcat \$ ["fizz" The great thing about this implementation is that when we get the natural change in requirements ? that we are supposed to print ?zork? for multiples of seven ? we can accommodate that change by simply adding the line that does so :

16. Weekly Update 502

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 00:14:13 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-502/>

It's a fascinating display of leverage: the ShinyHunters folks, with very limited resources and experience (their demographic will be teenagers to their early 20s), consistently gaining access to the data of massive brands. Not through technical ingenuity alone (although I'm sure there's a portion

17. The Impossible Things We Have to Believe

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 05 May 2026 17:09:12 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/the-impossible-things-we-have-to-believe/>

?Alice laughed. ?There?s no use trying,? she said. ?One can?t believe impossible things.? I daresay you haven?t had much practice,? said the Queen. ?When I was your age, I always did it for half-an-hour a day. Why, sometimes I?ve believed as many as six impossible things before breakfast. ? Through the looking-glass, Lewis Carrol To stay sane, we have to accept that our climate is going completely haywire, but that it is ok to mostly ignore that since saving ourselves is apparently not cost-effective.

18. Bu yaz?da, BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 mRNA a??s?n?n kaynak kodunu karakter karakter inceleyece?iz

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 02 Jan 2021 08:12:20 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/biontech-pfizer-mrna-a%C5%9F%C4%B1lar%C4%B1n%C4%B1n-kaynak-kodu/>

NOT Bu yaz?, <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/reverse-engineering-source-code-of-the-biontech-pfizer-vaccine/> adresindeki yaz?n?n T?rk?e ?evirisidir.

<https://gist.github.com/ugurkoltuk/2f87d8038d4fd42f4c6ad13472966797> Ho?geldiniz! Bu yaz?da, BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 mRNA a??s?n?n kaynak kodunu karakter karakter inceleyece?iz. Bu yaz?y? anla???l?r?k ve do?ruluk a??s?ndan g?zden ge?iren pek ?ok insana te?ekk?r ederim. T?m hatalar yine de benim hatalar?md?r ve hatalar? h?zla bert@hubertnet.nl ya da @bert_hu_bert adreslerinden birine bildirmenizi rica ederim (evirmenin notu: ?eviri ya da T?rk?e dil

hatalar?n? da a?a??daki yorum b  m  n  kullanarak bildirmenizi rica ederim.) Kula?a yanl?? geliyor olabilir - sonu a a??, kolunuzdan damar?n?za enjekte edilen bir s?v?.

19. Reverse Engineering Source Code of the Biontech Pfizer Vaccine: Part 2

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 31 Dec 2020 12:22:03 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/part-2-reverse-engineering-source-code-of-the-biontech-pfizer-vaccine/>

All BNT162b2 vaccine data on this page is sourced from this World Health Organization document.

This is a living page, shared already so people can get going! But check back frequently for updates. Translation: Français / ??? In short: the vaccine mRNA has been optimized by the manufacturer by changing bits of RNA from (say) UUU to UUC, and people would like to understand the logic behind these changes. This challenge is quite close to what cryptologists and reverse engineering people encounter regularly.